

Raghava KK, 2021

The Orgasm Project

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La petite mort

Oct 7th 2021

Raghava KK 2021

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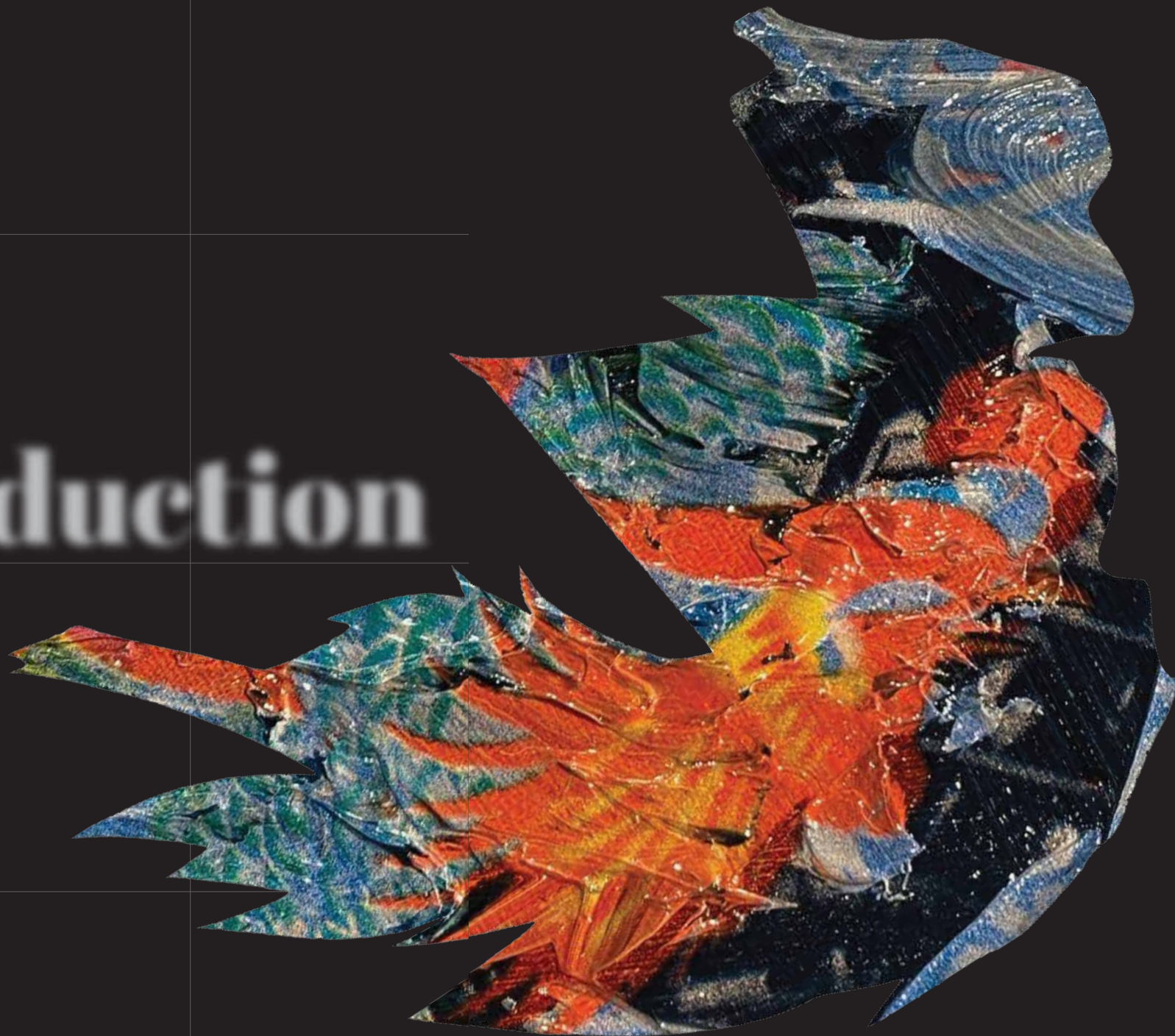
	Raghava KK, 2021	The Orgasm Project		Raghava KK, 2021	The Orgasm Project	Raghava KK, 2021
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	Artist: Raghava KK Collaborators: Abhijeet Satani Harshit Agrawal Artmatr Curatorial advisor: Myna Mukherjee			4. Beyond The Artwork 60	5. The Team 66	
	Raghava KK, 2021					The Orgasm Project



Dedicated to

“
*There are some orgasms
I regret and those that I don't*
- to Rudra, Anaga, Jaya and Aadya
”

Introduction



		Raghava KK, 2021 La Petite Mort I - 74.75" x 74.5" x 1.75" Oil on Canvas
La Petite Mort	Raghava KK, 2021	

In early 2017, after a heartbreaking divorce, I finally went to Burning Man, where I had the vision for an ambitious project — to imagine a whole new ecosystem for the artist seeking spiritual transcendence. I built out a vision that was like an art statement/manifesto hybridized onto a business plan — a 200 year plan for crypto art.

Unfortunately, I found it difficult to convince the very polarised (binary-language using) worlds of art and business to come together to create a decentralised global repository of human imagination stored on the blockchain.

I spent months imagining how the digital encounter could differ from the physical. How seemingly opposite values when confused could potentially liberate the art world from a polarized concept versus percept paradigm. And perhaps - perhaps — hopefully, open up some room for some (radically different) Eastern philosophical ideas. Alternate approaches and attitudes towards binary confusion/resolution.

I was thinking deeply about what the ethical consequences were for trying to digitize and then commodify everything in the world. What do the popular values of cuteness, frivolity and superficiality mean to the artworld? How do the binaries of popular and hi-art blur with the expansion of patronage etc.?

The biggest question on my mind was not about what could be digitized and - that was fairly easy for me to answer, the tougher question to answer was - what can not be potentially digitized?

I couldn't for the life of me come up with a single thing that is not potentially digitisable. So 6 years ago when I had the opportunity to imagine a 200 year vision for NFTs, one of the fundamental questions that came up during a conversation with my brother Karthik Kalyanaraman was - If everything is digitisable, is everything also a commodity? That got me to think - If everything is a commodity, what is the craziest thing that I can sell? By crazy I

mean the most intimate, personal and non-sellable item that I could think of.

Of course my mind thought of The Orgasm (also, and so expressively, called 'la petite mort', or 'the little death' in French)

The orgasm is that experience where the mental and physical meld. I experience it as a binary confusion because the death of eros gives rise to new potential life. It got me thinking of whether I can have a erotic relationship with my imagination? and could that be digitized too?

On the other side, I have this idea that not only can it be digitised it can also have multiple manifestations and experiences or be turned back into something physical.

I took a physical, emotional and visceral experience and turned it into a digital record which was then visualized and finally brought it into the physical realm to create a completely fresh sensual encounter.

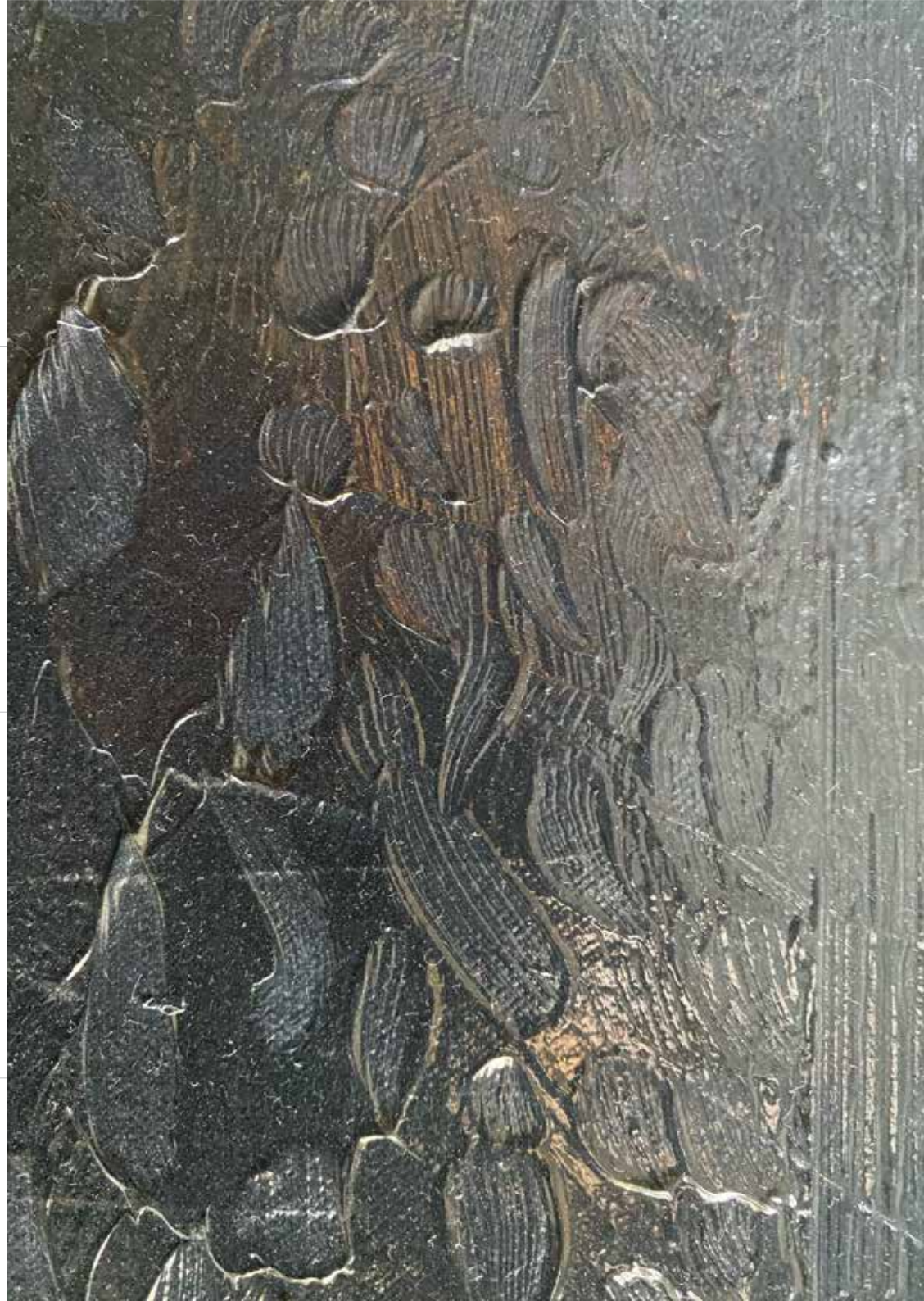
This work is the result of a collaboration between a material scientist and artist - Ben Tritt, Data scientist and AI artist - Harshit Agrawal and a neuroscientist - Abhijeet Satani.

Raghava KK,
New York,
2021



Burning Man X Sotheby's

Burning Man Project and Sotheby's are collaborating to produce Boundless Space: The Possibilities of Burning Man, a charitable online auction that will offer up for sale an eclectic, genre-defying selection of artworks, collectibles, mutant vehicles, NFTs, and experiences. Funds raised by Boundless Space will support participating artists, help ensure the not-for-profit's long-term survival, and fund their Arts and Civic Engagement programs.



The Process





Step 1 The Idea

Karthik Kalyanaraman asking Raghava KK (brothers and co-curators of 64/1 - an art collective dedicated to blurring the lines between art, art criticism and art education) the question



Raghava and Abhijeet Satani announce at FofX festival that they will one day sell Raghava's orgasm as a work of art.

“ One day soon, we shall capture our orgasm and turn it into art ”

“ If everything is digitizable - is everything also for sale? Does that sit right with you, ethically? - Karthik to Raghava ”



Video announcement of Raghava and Abhijeet at FofX festival. Uttarakhand, 2019. Video credit: Lipan





Step 2

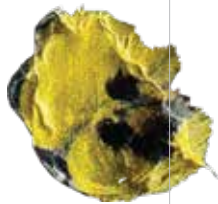


Image of Raghava getting prepped for the capture of brainwave.
Bangalore, 2021. Photo credit: Raghava KK Studio



Image of Raghava getting prepped for the capture of brainwave.
Bangalore, 2021. Photo credit: Raghava KK Studio



Brainwave activity capture tests with music and painting. Bangalore, 2021.
Photo credit: Raghava KK Studio



Image of Raghava and Abhijeet monitoring the brainwaves. Bangalore, 2021.
Photo credit: Raghava KK Studio



Image of equipment developed by Abhijeet Satani used in brainwave
data capture. Bangalore, 2021. Photo credit: Abhijeet Satani

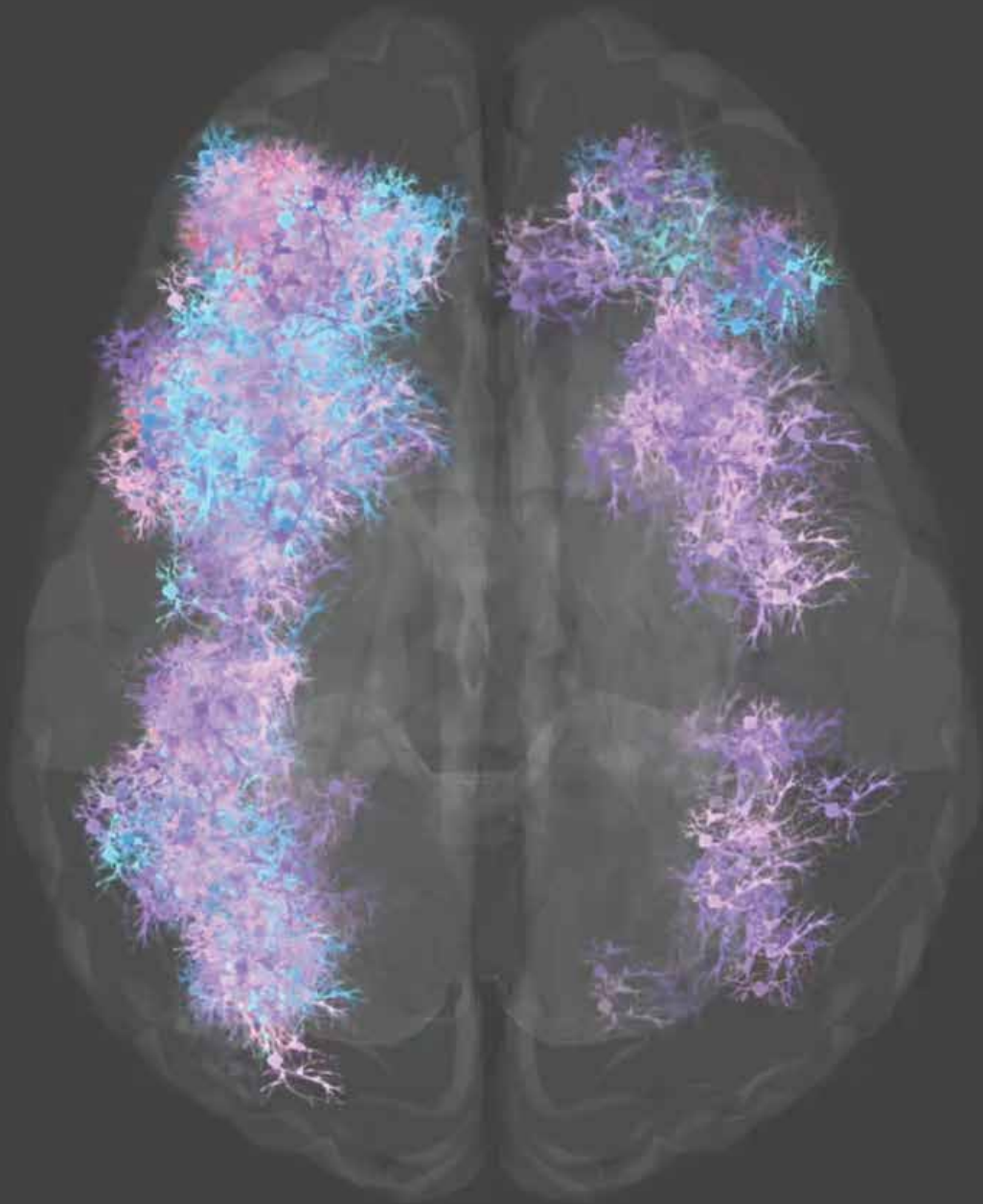


Image of brain 15 secs before orgasm. Bangalore, 2021.
Image credit: Abhijeet Satani

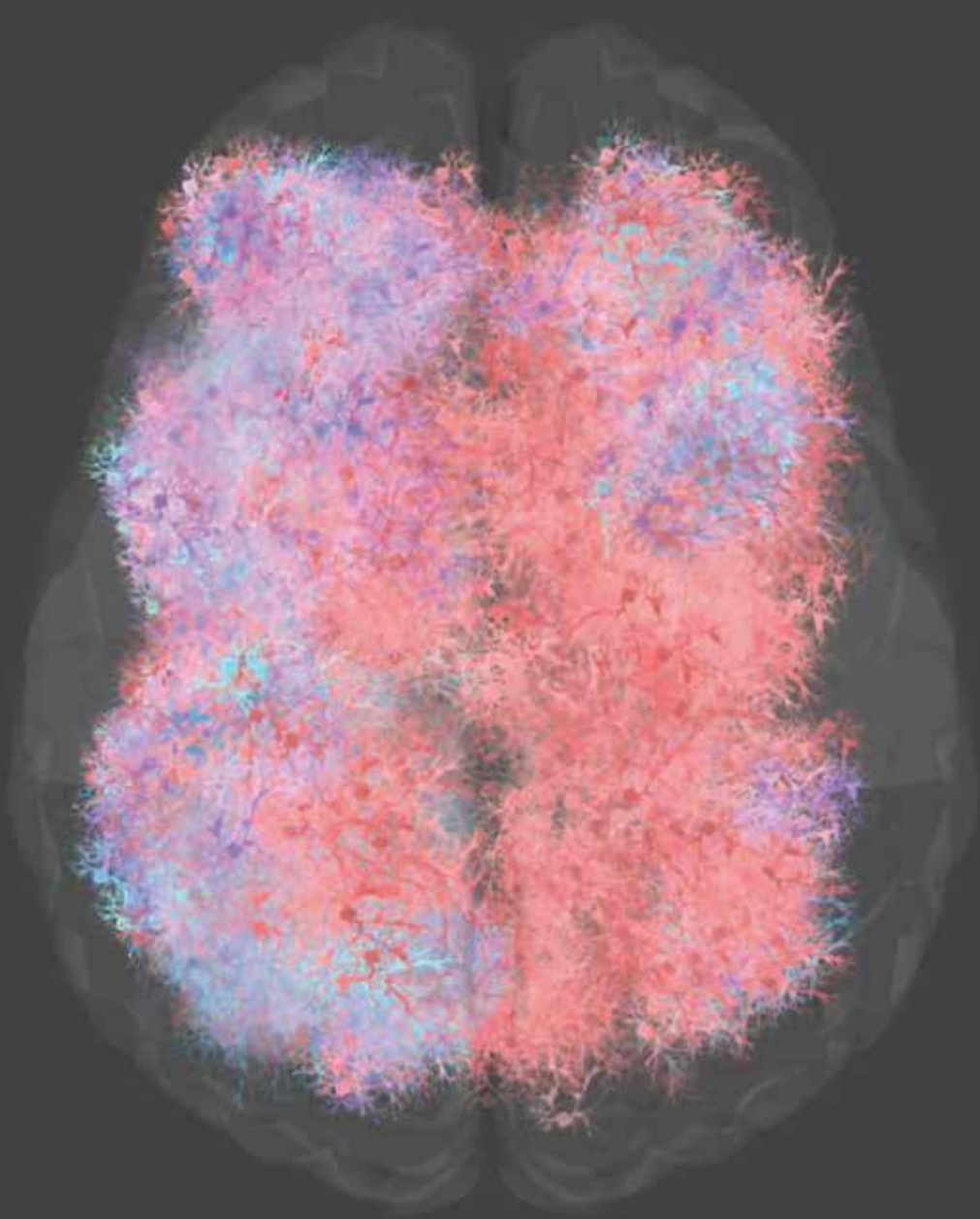


Image of brain during peak orgasm . Bangalore, 2021.
Image credit: Abhijeet Satani

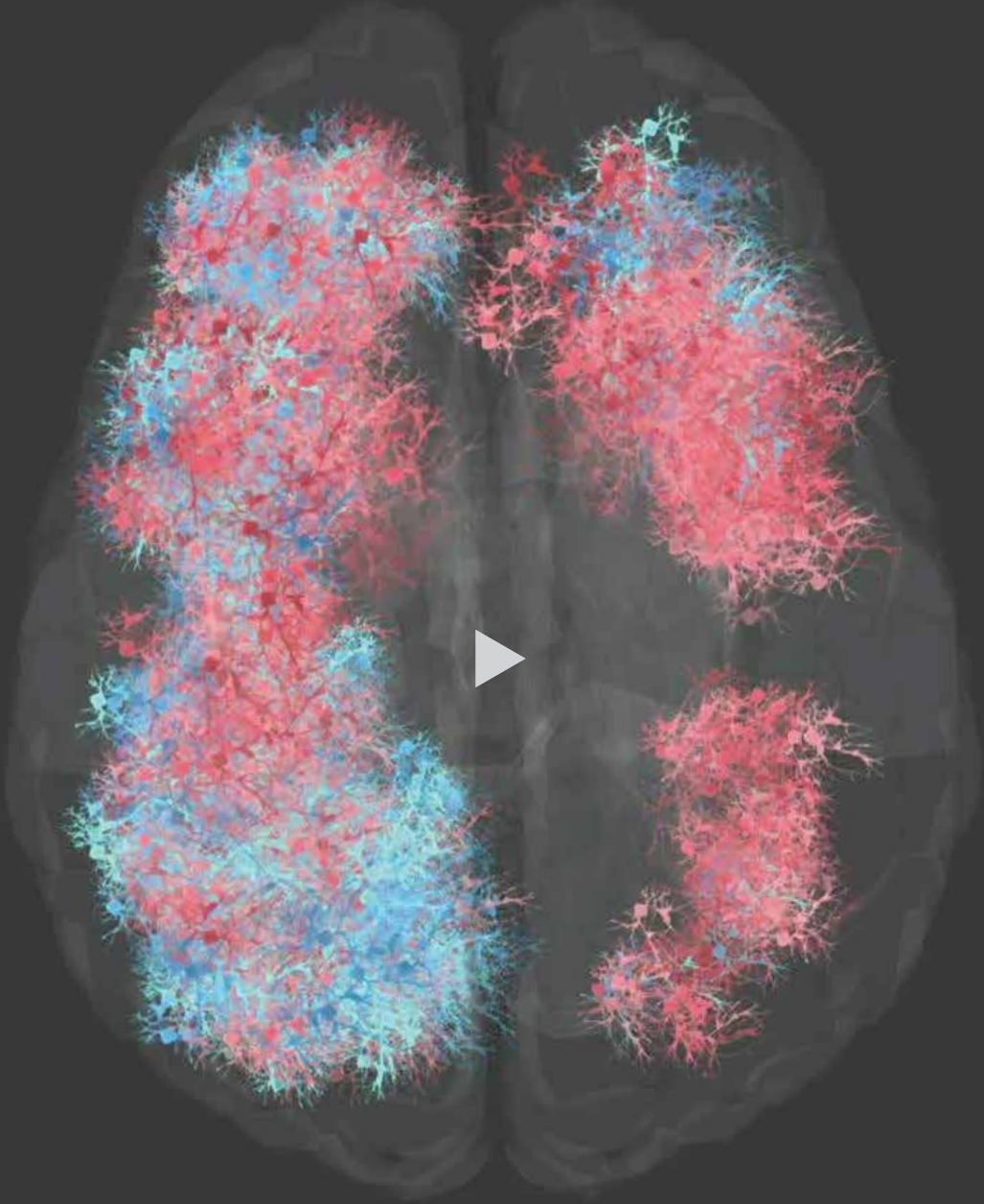
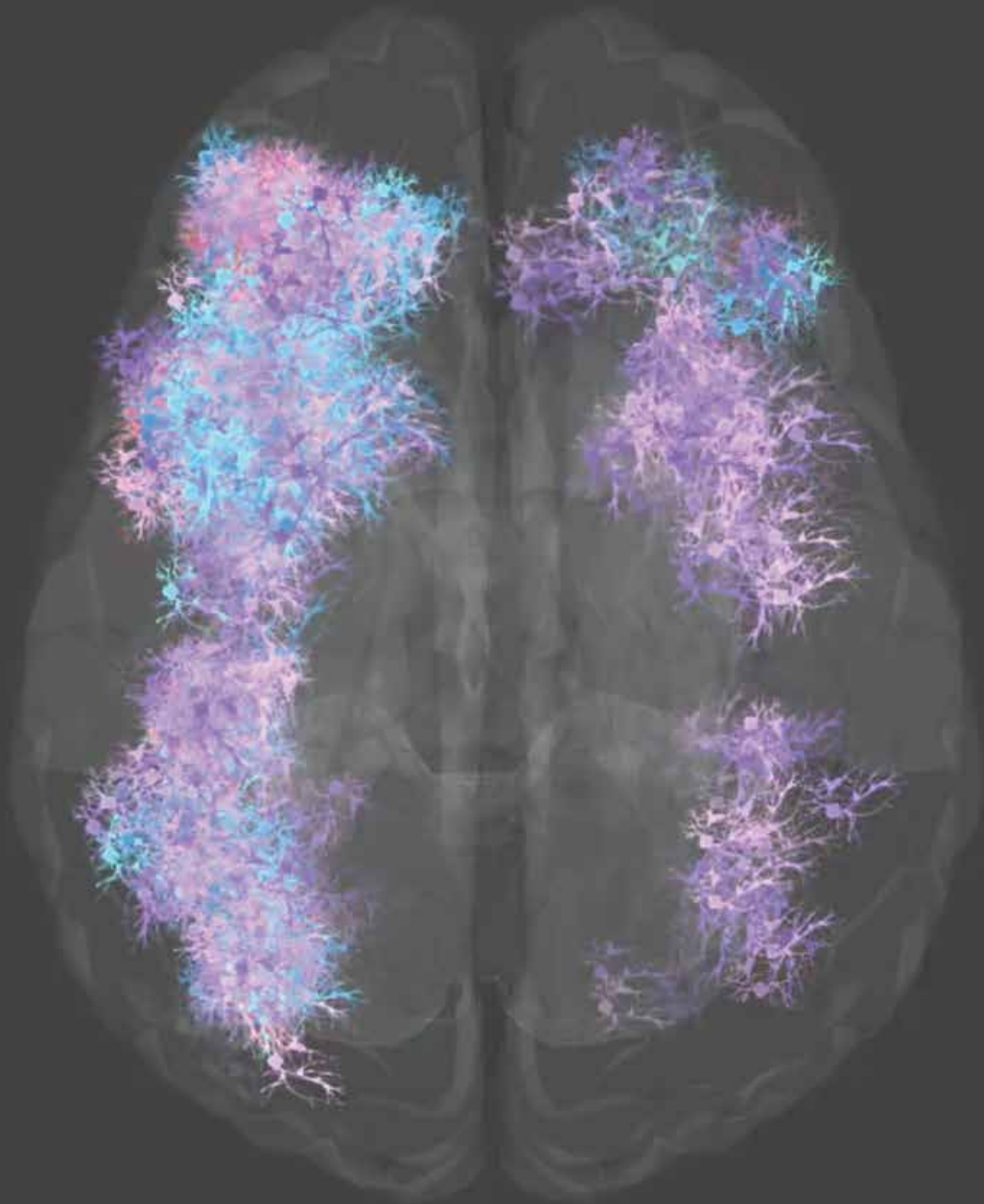
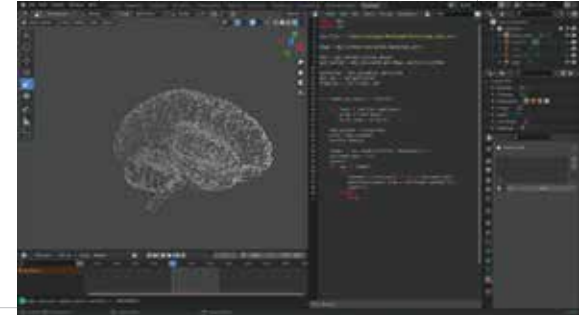


Image of brain 15 secs after orgasm. Bangalore, 2021.
Image credit: Abhijeet Satani

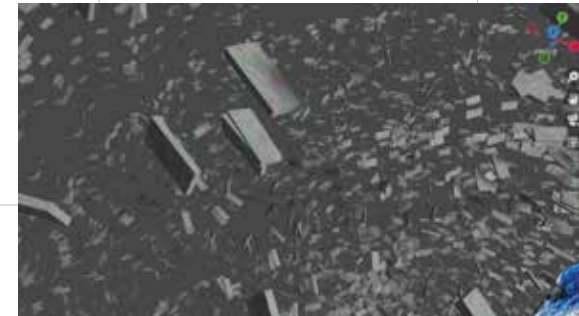
Orgasm primitive visualization. Bangalore, 2021.
Video credit: Abhijeet Satani



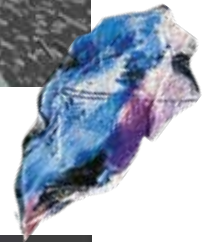
Steps



Neuro-data is brought into blender for 3D render 2021.
Image credit: Harshit Agrawal



Each neuron is turned into an individual brush stroke.
Screenshot of stroke detail in blender Mumbai, 2021.
Image credit: Harshit Agrawal



Video of neuro visualization at climax. Mumbai, 2021.
Video credit: Harshit Agrawal

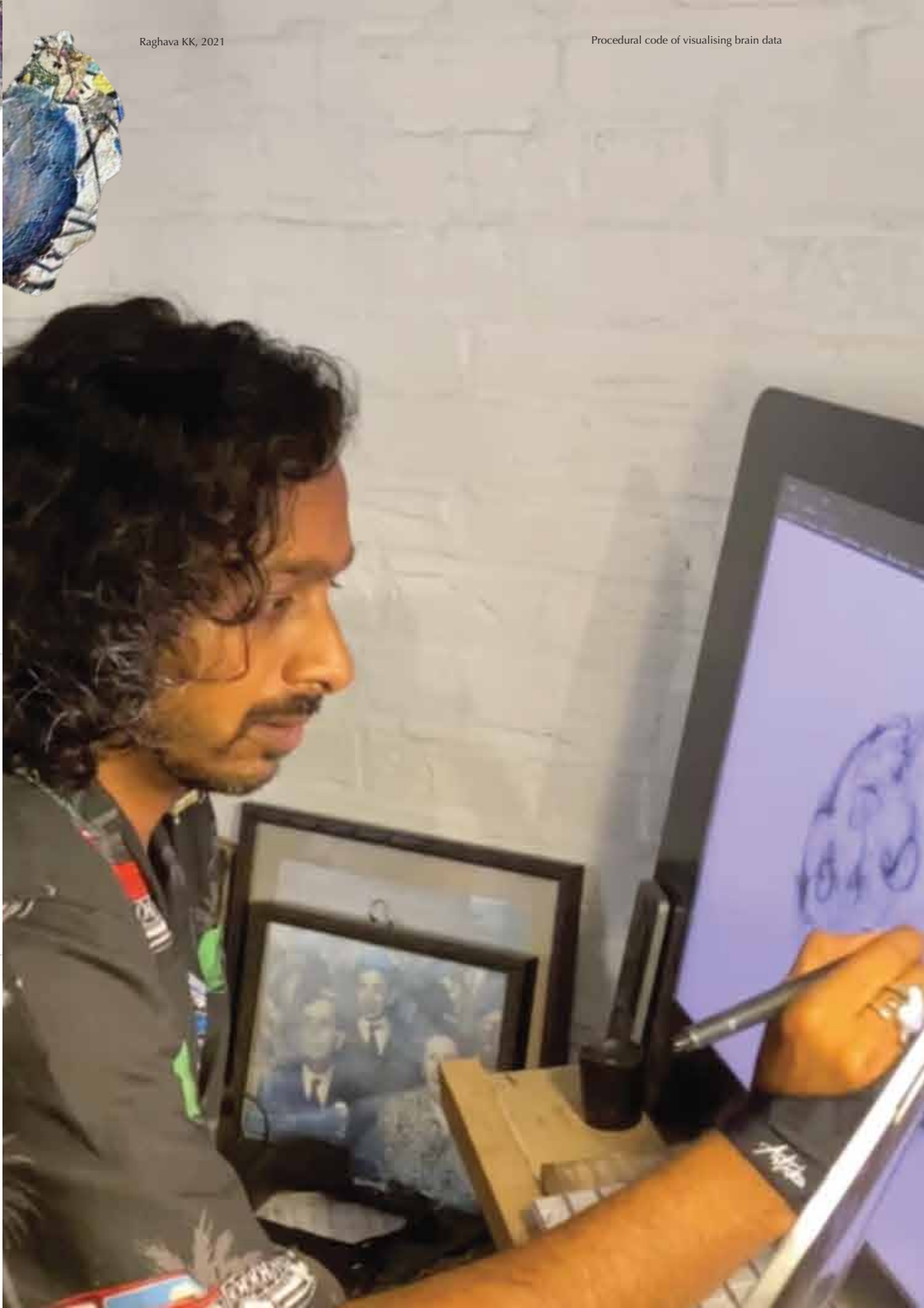
The Orgasm Project

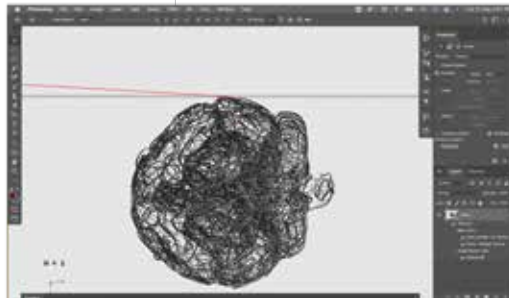
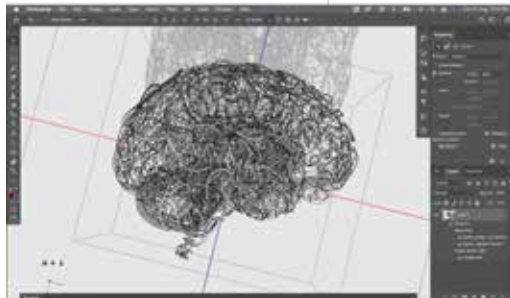
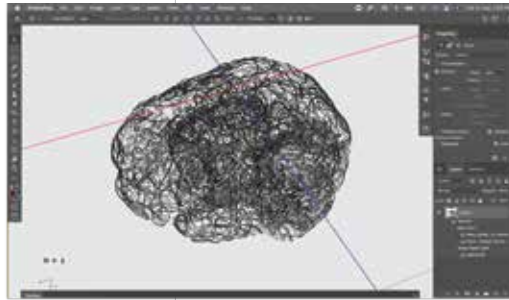
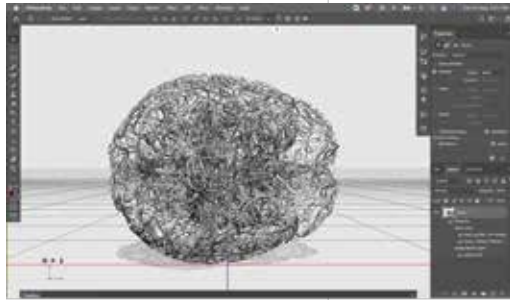
The Orgasm Project

Raghava KK, 2021

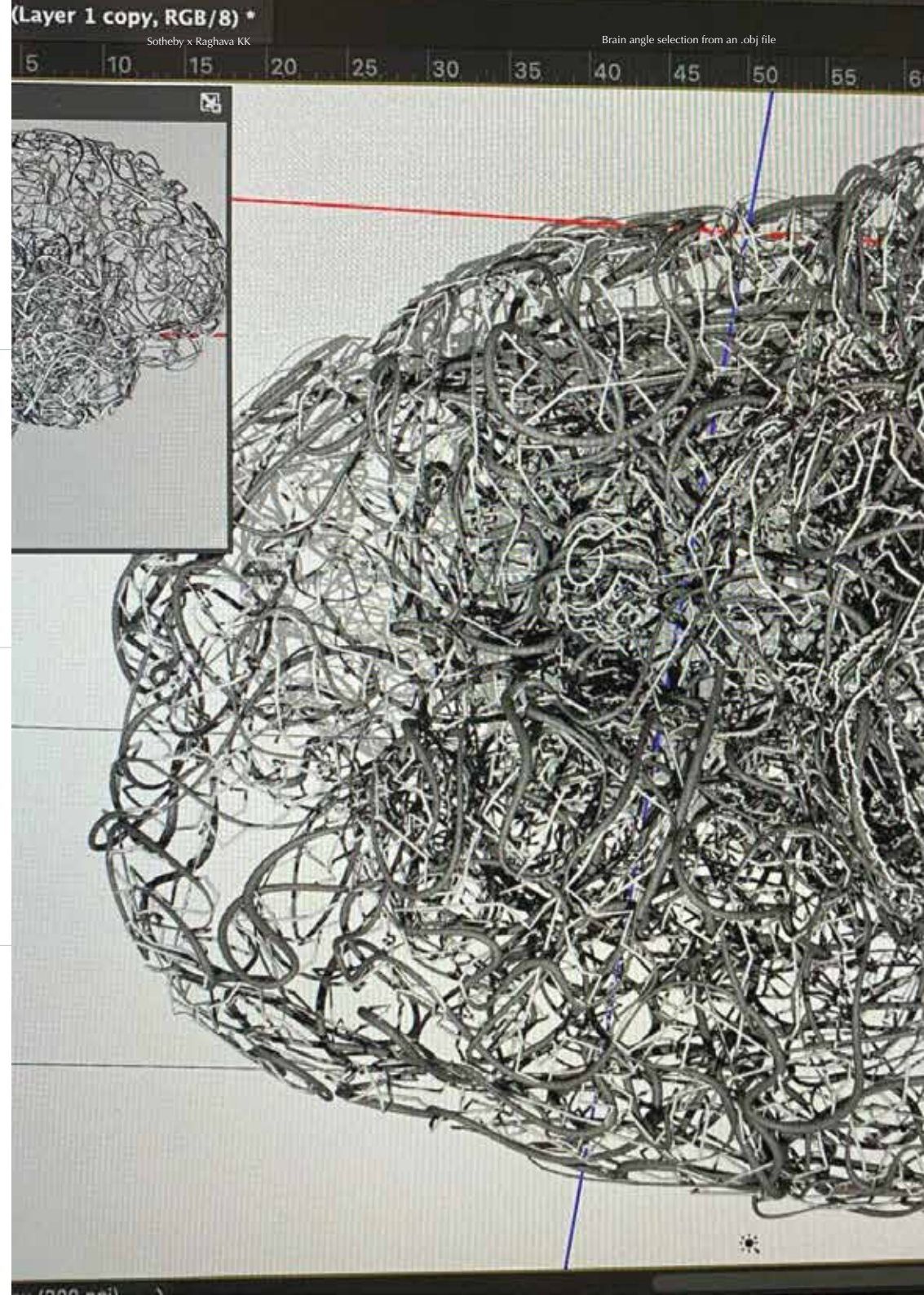
Raghava KK, 2021

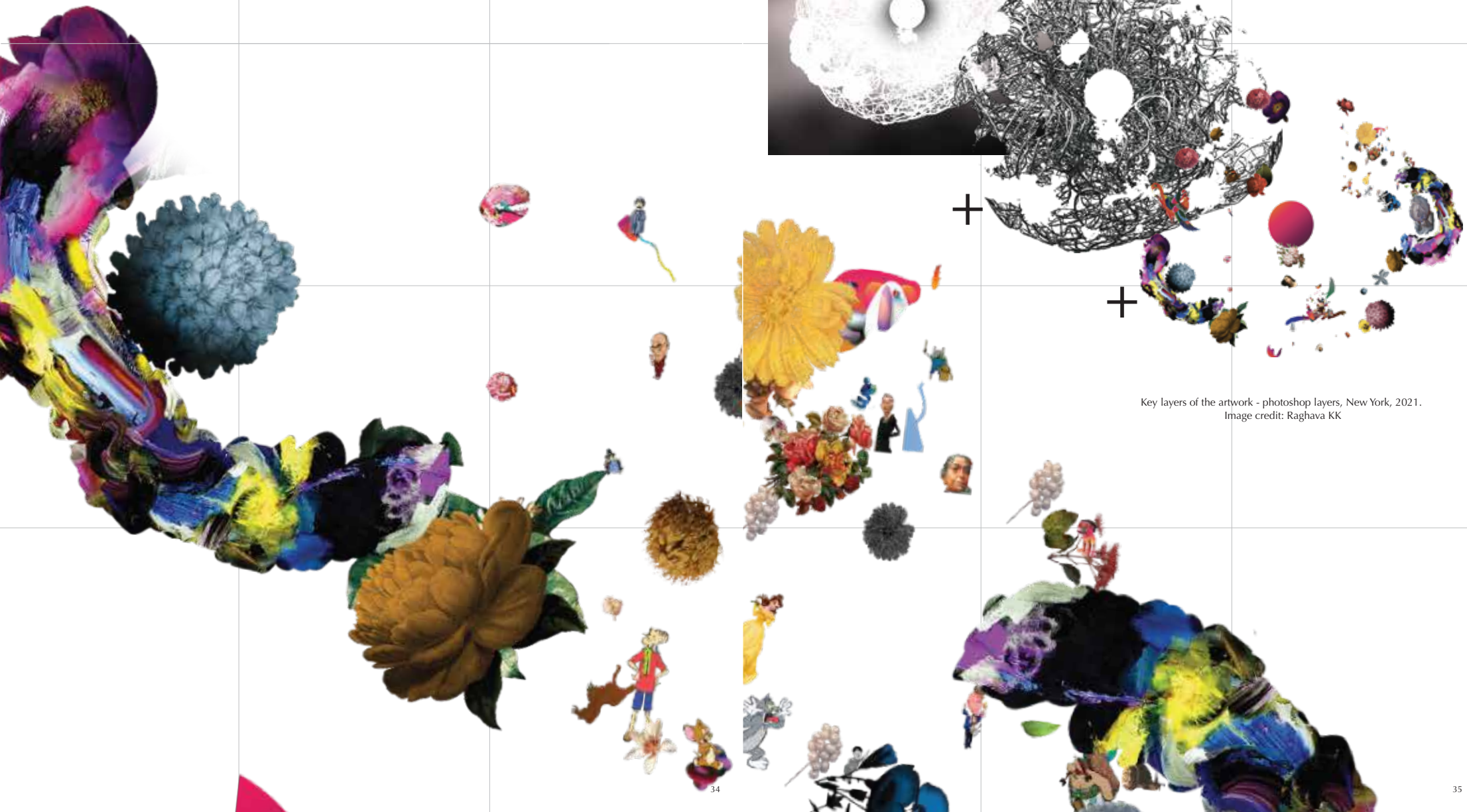
Procedural code of visualising brain data





Brain angle selection from an .obj file on Photoshop 2020, New York, 2021.
Image credit: Raghava KK





Key layers of the artwork - photoshop layers, New York, 2021.
Image credit: Raghava KK



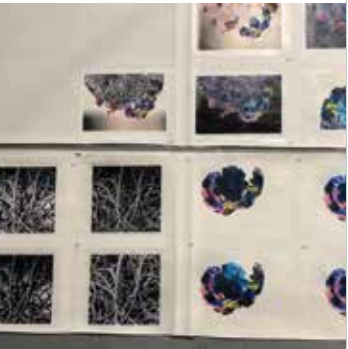
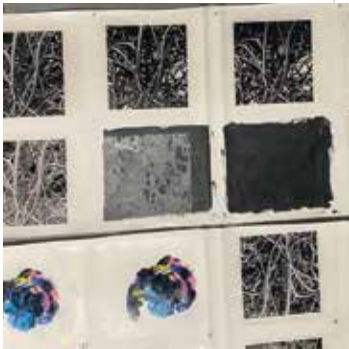
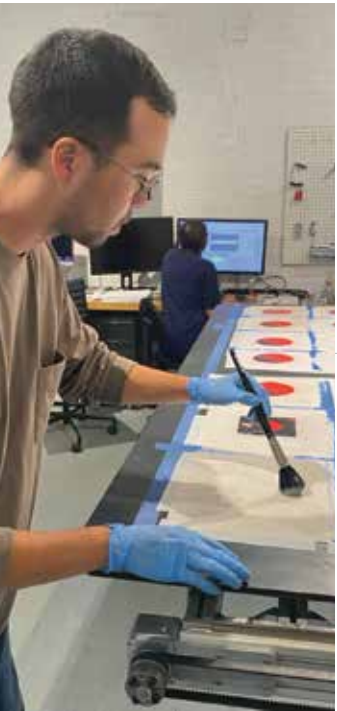
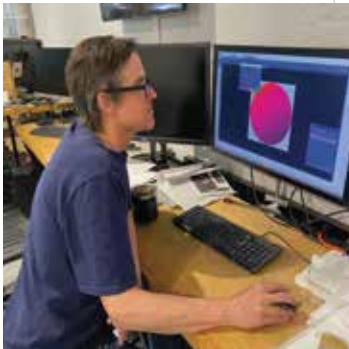
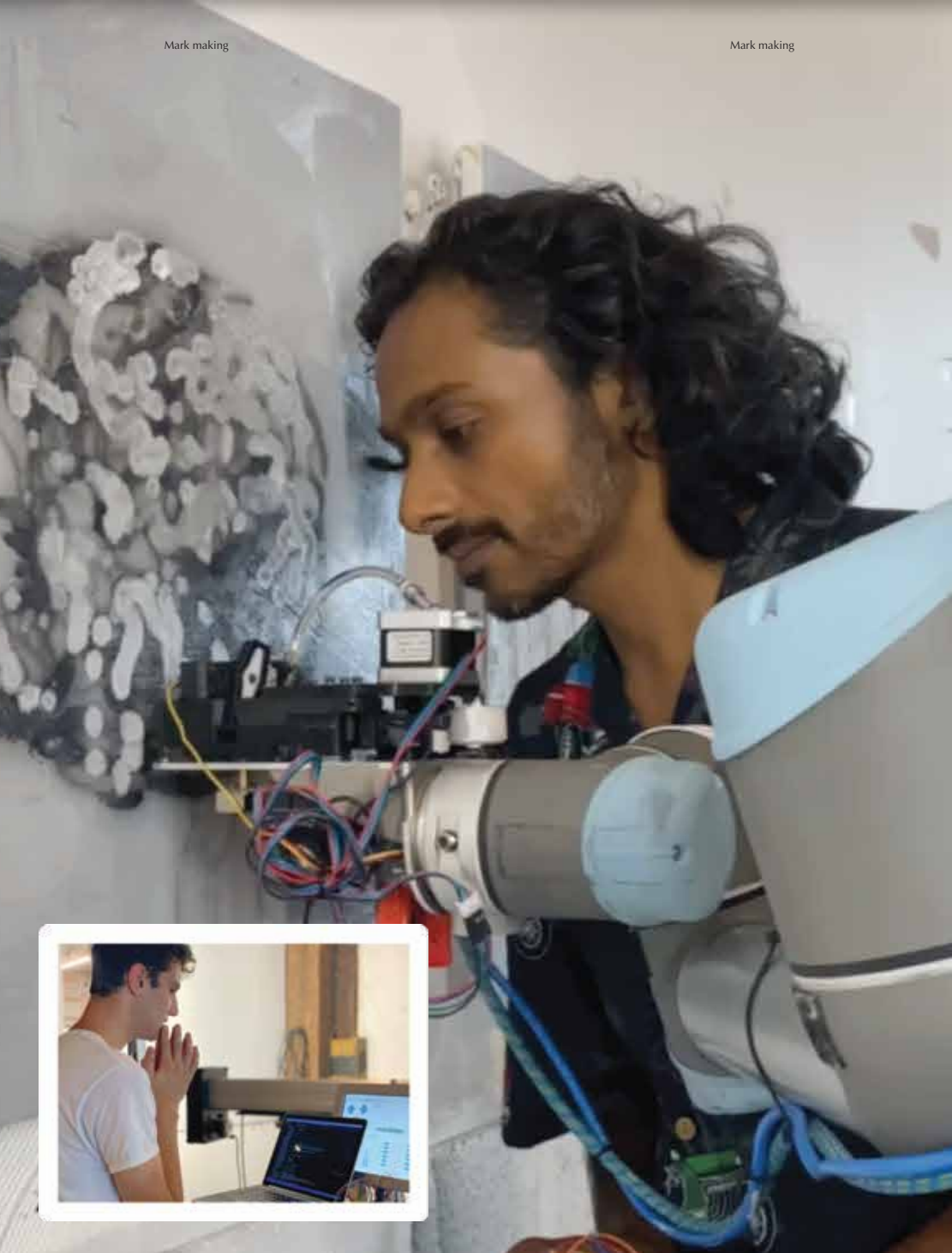


Image of colour and substrate tests. New York, 2021.
Image credit: Artmatr



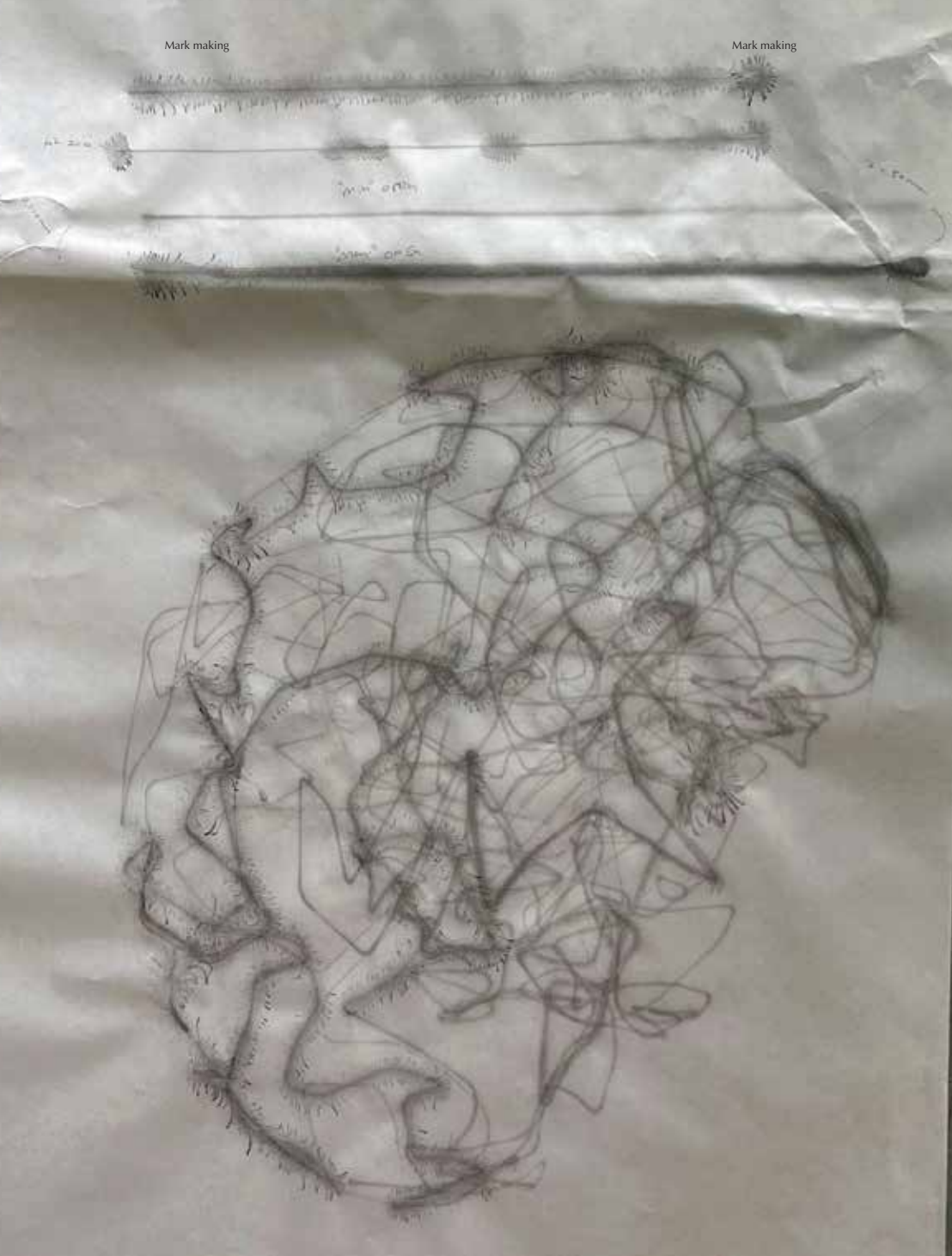


Experiments in mark making for The Orgasm Project. New York, 2021.
Image credit: Artmatr



Experiments in mark making for The Orgasm Project. New York, 2021.
Image credit: Artmatr





Experiments in mark making for The Orgasm Project. New York, 2021.
Image credit: Artmatr



Experiments in mark making for The Orgasm Project. New York, 2021.
Image credit: Artmatr

Mark making

Mark making

Mark making

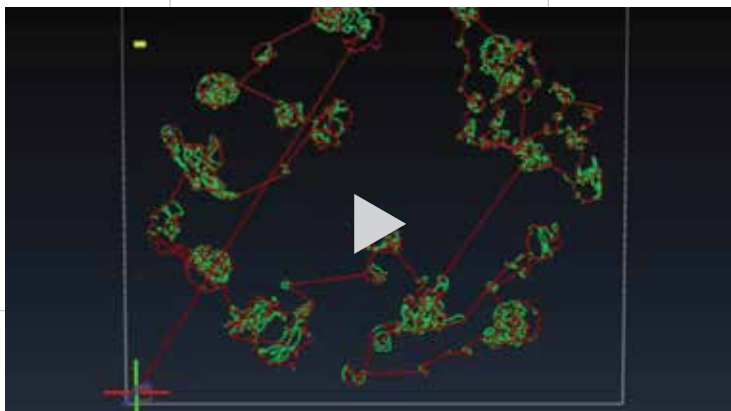
Mark making



SAD 75%
max 0.05e
D=10 cm



Special oil pigments were prepared in a material science lab setup by Artmatr in Israel for this project
Image of the vials. New York, 2021.
Image credit: Artmatr

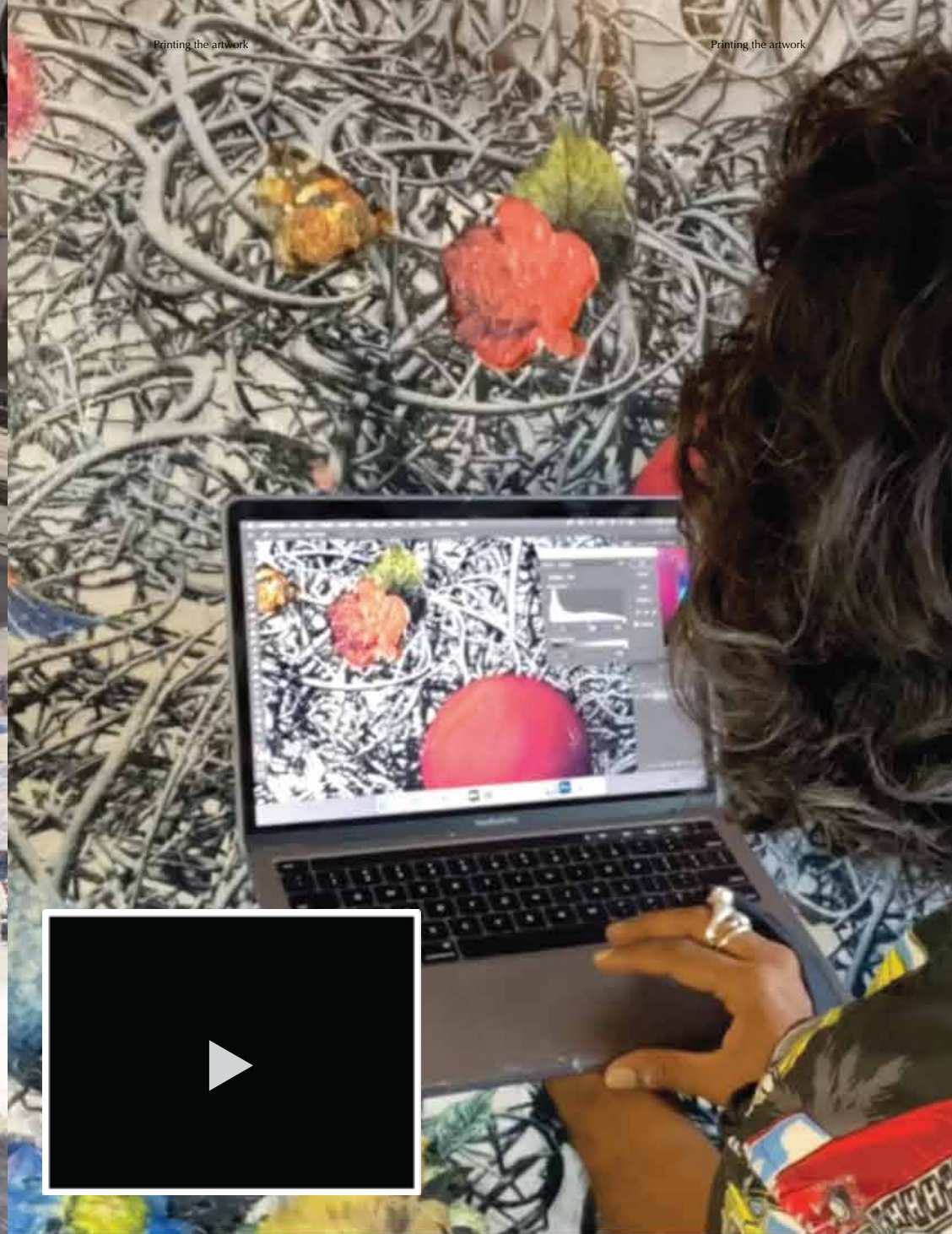


Turning the contours of the artwork into G-code
Video of G-code outputs. New York, 2021.
Video credit: ArtMatr





Image of Raghava painting along with Artmatr robots at the Artmatr lab.
New York, 2021.
Image credit: Artmatr



Time lapse video of the printing process. New York, 2021.
Video credit: Artmatr.

The Artwork





Physical rendering of Raghava's oragasm titled "La petite mort".
New York, 2021. Photo credit: Raghava KK.



Le petite mort Study 1, New York, 2021.
Photo credit: Raghava KK



Le petite mort Study 2, New York, 2021.
Photo credit: Raghava KK



Le petite mort Study 3, New York, 2021.
Photo credit: Raghava KK

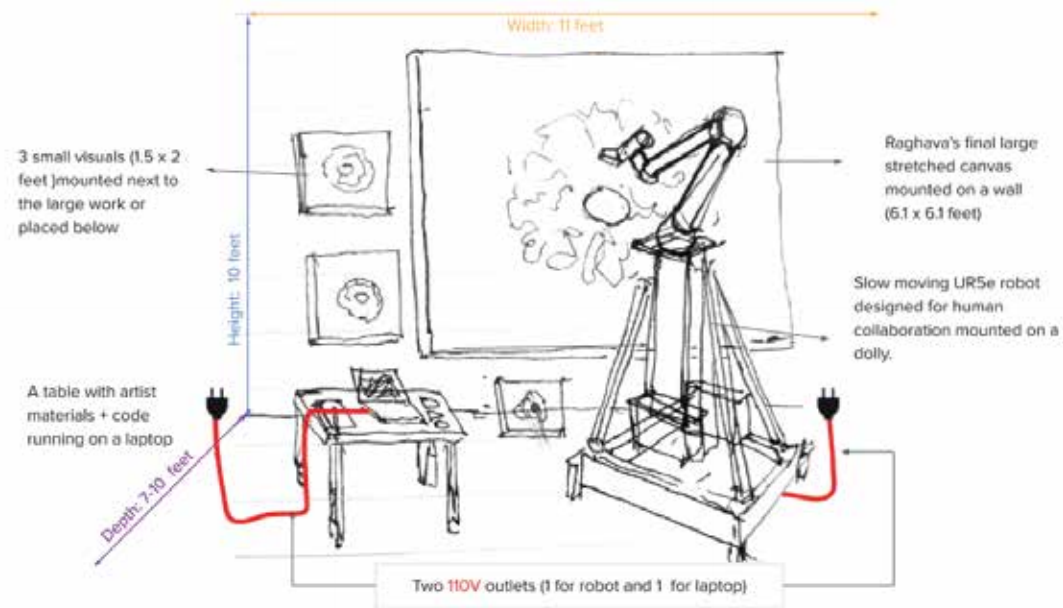


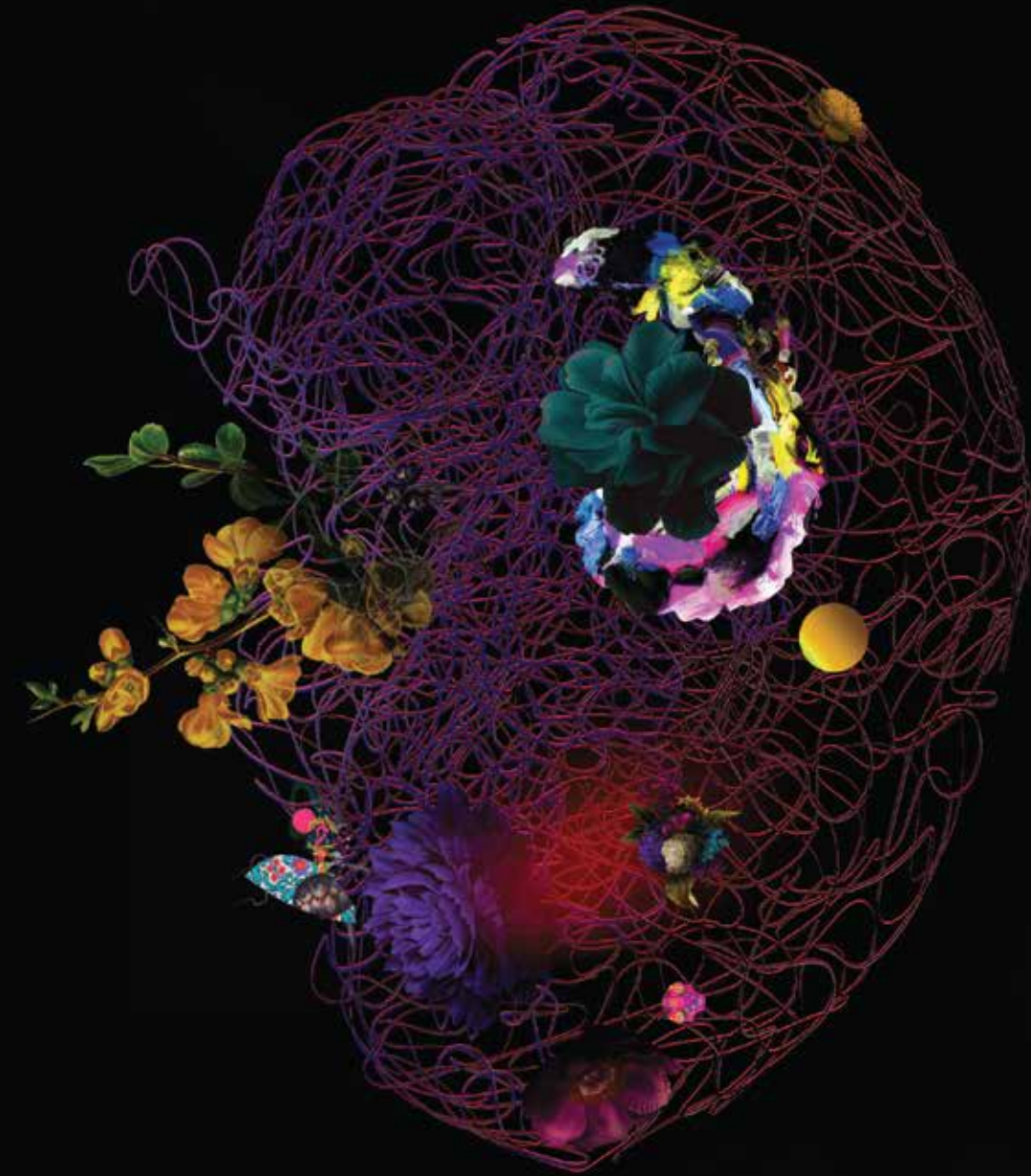
Image of the sketch for the final installation.
At the Sotheby's HQ New York, 2021.
Image credit: Artmatr.



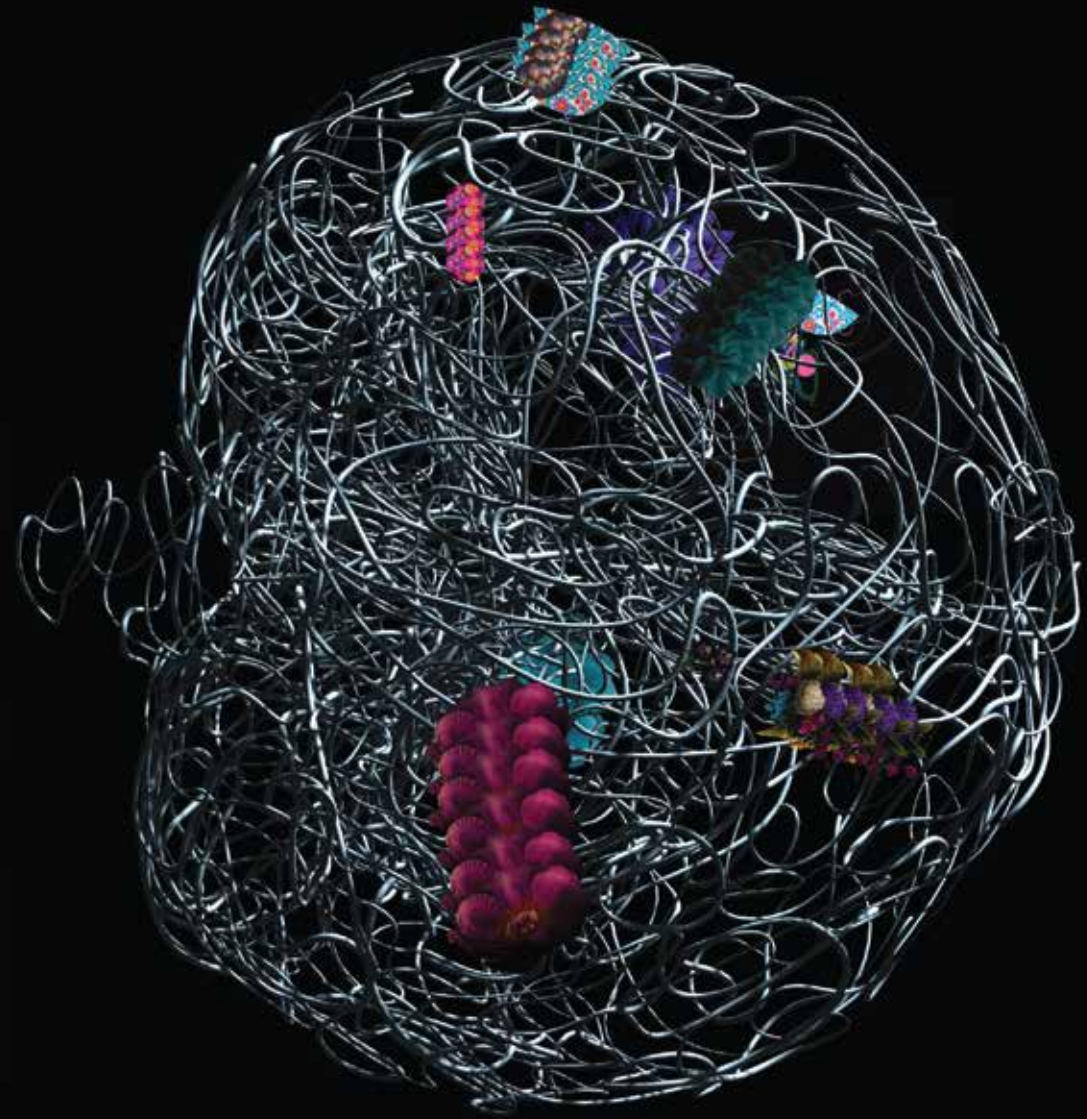
Image of the test installation. New York, 2021. I
mage credit: Artmatr.

Beyond The Artwork

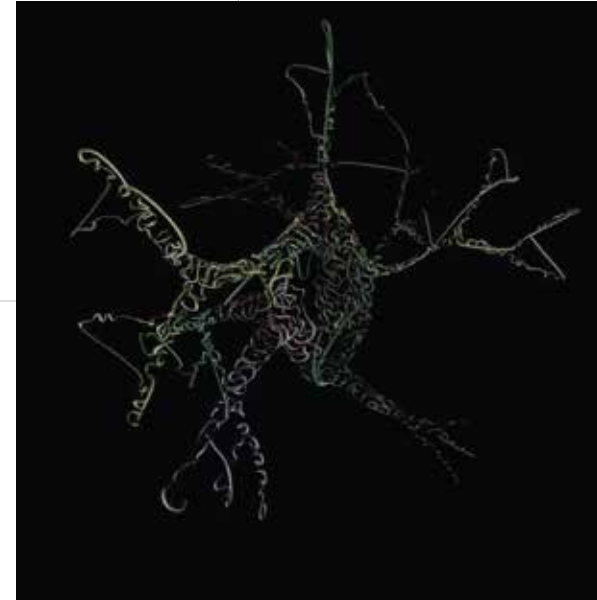
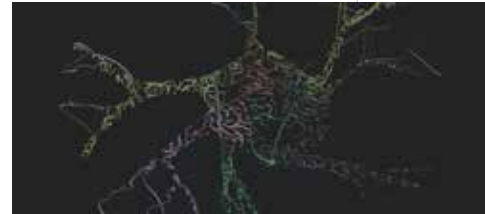
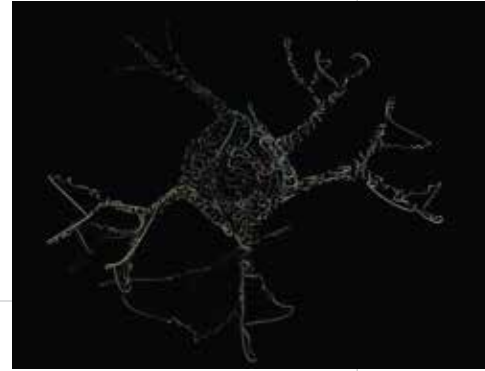




Fake Male Orgasm generated by an AI that studied multiple male
orgasms - photoshop file, New York, 2021.
Image credit: Raghava KK



Fake Female Orgasm generated by an AI that studied multiple female
orgasms - photoshop file, New York, 2021.
Image credit: Raghava KK





Raghava KK has pioneered a groundbreaking body of diverse works that explore transcendence through the lens of the current digital era. Featured on CNN's list of ten fascinating thinkers, authors and provocateurs in 2010, Raghava's work traverses traditional forms of painting, installation and performance, while his practice embraces new media (artificial intelligence, neuro-feedback, biohacking, board and video games, crypto currencies etc), to express post-human contemporary realities.



His lectures, including 5 TED talks, are known for inspiring audiences to expand their social and psychological selves, using art.

Netflix, this year launched an episode on Raghava in the Creative Indians Series.

Raghava's storytelling migrates among his various disciplines through 50 foot live paintings, interactive books on Apple's iPad (Pop-it, won a Kirkus book award that year), Album designs for Erykah Badu and Paul Simon, as creator in residence at Viacom, NY, Raghava launched Must# at both TED and Viacom HQ, A Visual Empathy Algorithm that learned how the viewer made meaning visually and pushed him to transcend the limits of his taste.

Raghava has mentored several creative entrepreneurs by infusing his philosophy into their processes and products. In 2010, Raghava co-founded and chaired The INK Fellowship (The TED of India), India's leading global multidisciplinary fellowship program. Raghava was inducted into the National Geographic Society in 2013 as an Explorer, for pushing the boundaries of scientific exploration through art.



In 2015, he created a new compositional process, part human and part algorithm-driven through his collaborative project SOZO - a painting machine, developed for him by Artmatr an offshoot of the MIT Media lab.

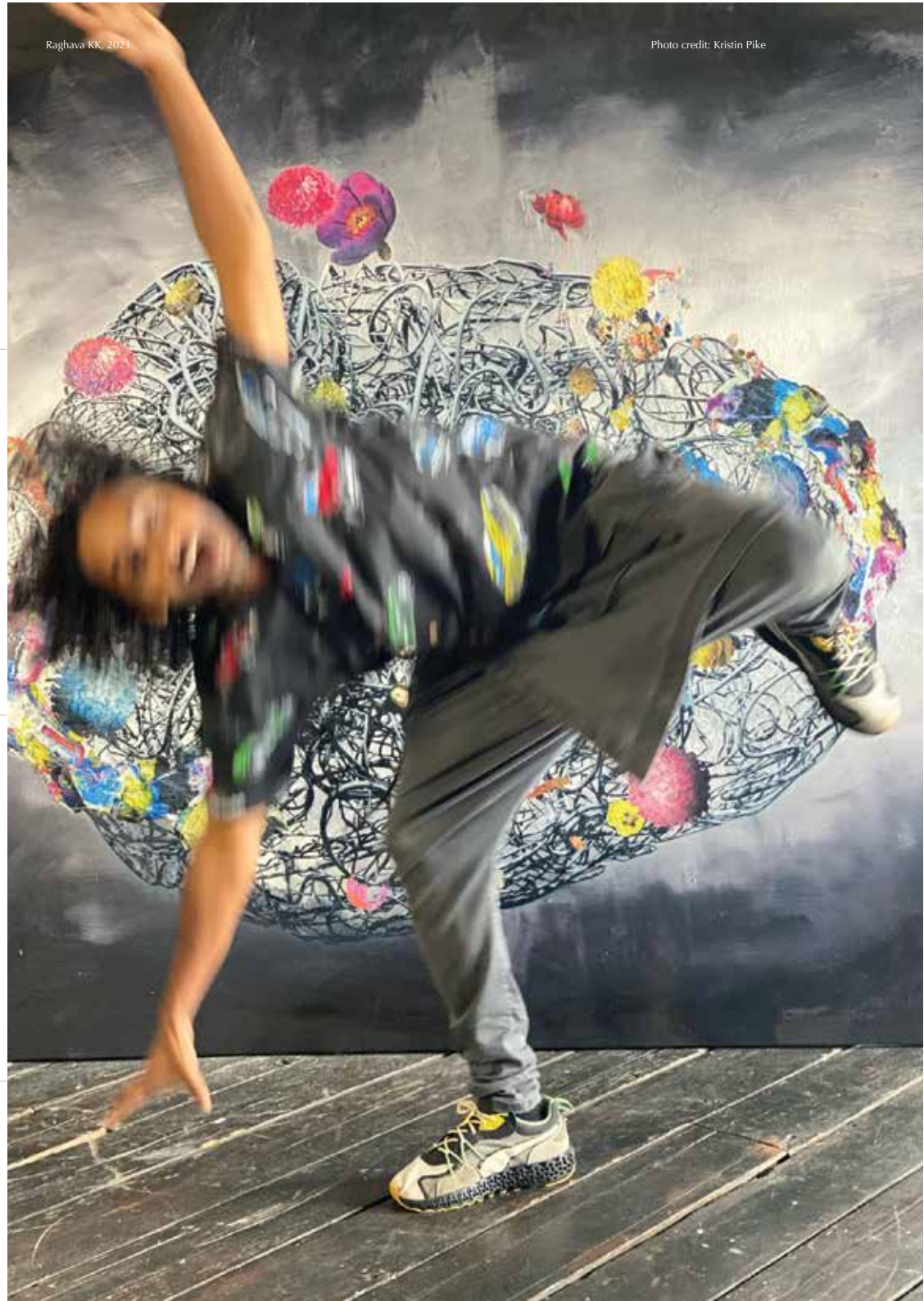
In 2017, Raghava was invited by Jeff Bezos to conduct an art workshop for leading creative minds from around the world. The same year, as a partner, he helped set up the vision and strategy for Roundglass, India's largest venture fund for wellbeing.

In 2018, Raghava co-founded 64/1, an art collective dedicated to blurring the lines between art, art criticism and art education.

In 2020, Raghava created Eye Candy - a performance art piece on Instagram (with Under25 studios) in an attempt to reach out to a completely different audience, than the usual audience for high art, through a completely different art form that combines monologue, painting and self-help.

In 2021, a collaborative AI art piece created with Harshit Agrawal and 64/1 (Karthik Kalyanaraman and Raghava KK - an art collective dedicated to blurring the lines between art, art criticism and art education) called Strange Genders was exhibited at Exostential - an AI art show at Emami Art Foundation, Kolkata. The artwork has currently been shortlisted for the Lumen Prize 2021.

He currently lives and works out of New York and Bangalore, India.





The team

TEAM: A truly global interdisciplinary collaborative project



Raghava KK
Artist



Myna Mukherjee
Curator



Abhijeet Satani
Neuroscientist



Harshit Agrawal
AI Artist



Ben Tritt
Founder, Artmatr



Kay Pike
Studio Manager,
Artmatr



Sonia Lewis
Director, Raghava KK
Studio



Jeff Leonard
Master printer



Gen Leonard
Roboticist



Jake Sorscher
Roboticist



Serotonin
Marketing agency



Brand Daily Project
Design team



Thank you

Aadya Raghava
Anaga Raghava
D Kalyanaraman
Jaya Raghava
Karthik Kalyanaraman
Keerthan Shankar
Kunal Sood
Leela Kalyanaraman
Maria Kreyn
Philippa Mothersill
Regina Sakhrani
Rudra Raghava
Shilo Shiv Suleman
Sotheby's team
Sunder Sakhrani
The Burning Man Project -
Kim Cook, Devyn Madsen, Muse Williams,
Kris Chant, Dan Weeks, Kye Horton

